

Part I Read and Know (30 marks,25 minutes)

1. What is the best translation of “国之大者”？

- A. Matters of national significance.
- C. Territory of a great size.
- B. Industry to develop infrastructure.
- D. People with patriotic spirit.

2 “不忘初心，牢记使命”：to remain/stay true to the Party's_____and_____

- A. original expectation; founding vision
- B. original aspiration; founding destiny
- C. original aspiration; founding mission
- D. original expectation; founding path

3. What is the best understanding of “爱人深者求贤急”？

- A. One should not only adopt the suggestions from people he/she cares about.
- B. One who governs a country must ensure the basic wellbeing and interests of its people
- C. One who deeply cares about the people will have a strong desire to seek out talent.
- D. One should not look for talent according to his/her individual affection.

4. What is the best translation of “讲信义、重情义、扬正义、守道义的大国形象”？

- A. A responsible major country that honors its word, honors chivalry, champions righteousness and respects personal sacrifices.
- B. A responsible major country that honors its word, values friendship, upholds justice, and champions integrity.

C. A duty-bound power that upholds the code of brotherhood, honors chivalry, upholds justice and respects integrity.

D. A duty-bound power that upholds the code of brotherhood, values friendship, champions righteousness and respects personal sacrifices.

We must follow a path with Chinese features and pursue a **holistic** approach to national security. We consider political security, the people's security, and the supremacy of national interests as three essential elements of an indivisible whole.

---Xi Jinping: *The Governance of China (Volume V)*

5. What does the underlined word "holistic" probably mean?

A. Conducive to health or physical wellbeing.

B. Based on the principle of treating any subject as a whole integrated system.

C. Having a positive influence on people's behavior or mental state.

D. Being in one piece and not broken or damaged.

Question 6 is based on the following text.

Every now and then, a complete blow-out of a restaurant is in order—for a celebration, special occasion or simply a self-caring treat. If there are just the two of you (or perhaps just the one), then sitting at a chef's table where you can chat to chefs and watch the magic happen is absolutely thrilling. Here you'll find a round-up of some of our favorite venues, from the fashionable feel of a Park Lane hotel like the Dorchester and exemplary local produce skillfully cooked on Skye, to the quiet, almost balletic drama of Simon Rogan's Aulis. As the feature says: entertaining, enlightening and delicious.

6. What is the main purpose of the text?

A. To promote various leisure and entertainment places

B. To compare different dining facilities in the city,

C. To highlight top venues for exceptional dining experiences.

D. To showcase the culinary skills of chefs at top restaurants.

Question 7 is based on the following text.

Despite common perceptions, Southeast Asia's water resources are far from inexhaustible. The region faces significant gaps in hitting water-centric Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). According to the Asian Development Bank, roughly 500 million individuals across Southeast Asia grapple with limited access to clean water, and over 1.1 billion have insufficient sanitation. Access to water is further complicated by concerns surrounding water security, driven by rapid urban growth and an expanding population. Predictions suggest an increase in water demand, putting existing water infrastructure under pressure. On the one hand, nations are thriving for more growth, which ultimately brings a higher standard of living, but on the other, this comes at a cost depleting their water resources.

7. Which of the following CANNOT be summarized from the text?

- A. Existing water infrastructure is rapidly wearing out.
- B. Southeast Asia's water resources are not inexhaustible.
- C. Nations pursue growth at the expense of water depletion.
- D. People in Southeast Asia lack sufficient access to clean water.

Questions 8 to 9 are based on the following text.

Here's a memorable beach moment: You're basking in the warm sun, toes in the sand, letting the gentle turn of the foam-capped waves lull you into a state of complete relaxation. As your eyes scan the endless horizon of blue on blue, you're rewarded with a school of dolphins making their way across the sea. There's no denying their signature shape as they leap from the water. If you don't see anything else extraordinary the rest of the day, you can take solace knowing you've witnessed one of nature's most playful and intelligent creatures in their natural habitat. Why not re-create that special toes-in-the-sand moment with our Blue Topaz Dolphin Pendant? The beloved sea mammal has been captured mid-jump in sterling silver. And, tucked into its fins is a full two carats of shimmering blue topaz.

8. What does the underlined word "solace" probably mean?

- A. Fortune. B. Boredom. C. Solitude. D. Comfort.

9.What is the best title for the text?

- A. A Beautiful Horizon of Blue on Blue B.A Wonderful Experience of Life.
C. A Perfect Symbol of Fun in the Sun D. A Necklace of Eternal Love.

Questions 10 to 11 are based on the following text.

More than forty years ago, when I was first admitted to the middle school, I used to feel extremely happy to know that I was born in a country whose history had already lasted 5,000 years. I say 5,000 years because it was actually the figure given to the youthful mind of my generation. The Sumerian civilization and the Egyptian civilization, we were told, might have started earlier; but they were also dead long ago. The Hindus, too, enjoy a long tradition, but their men of learning, till recently, never seemed to think it worthwhile to put their tradition on written records. So when all these things have been considered, China is certainly the oldest country still existing on this earth, and possesses the longest-and this is important-continuous written history of all the nations.



-The Beginning of Chinese Civilization

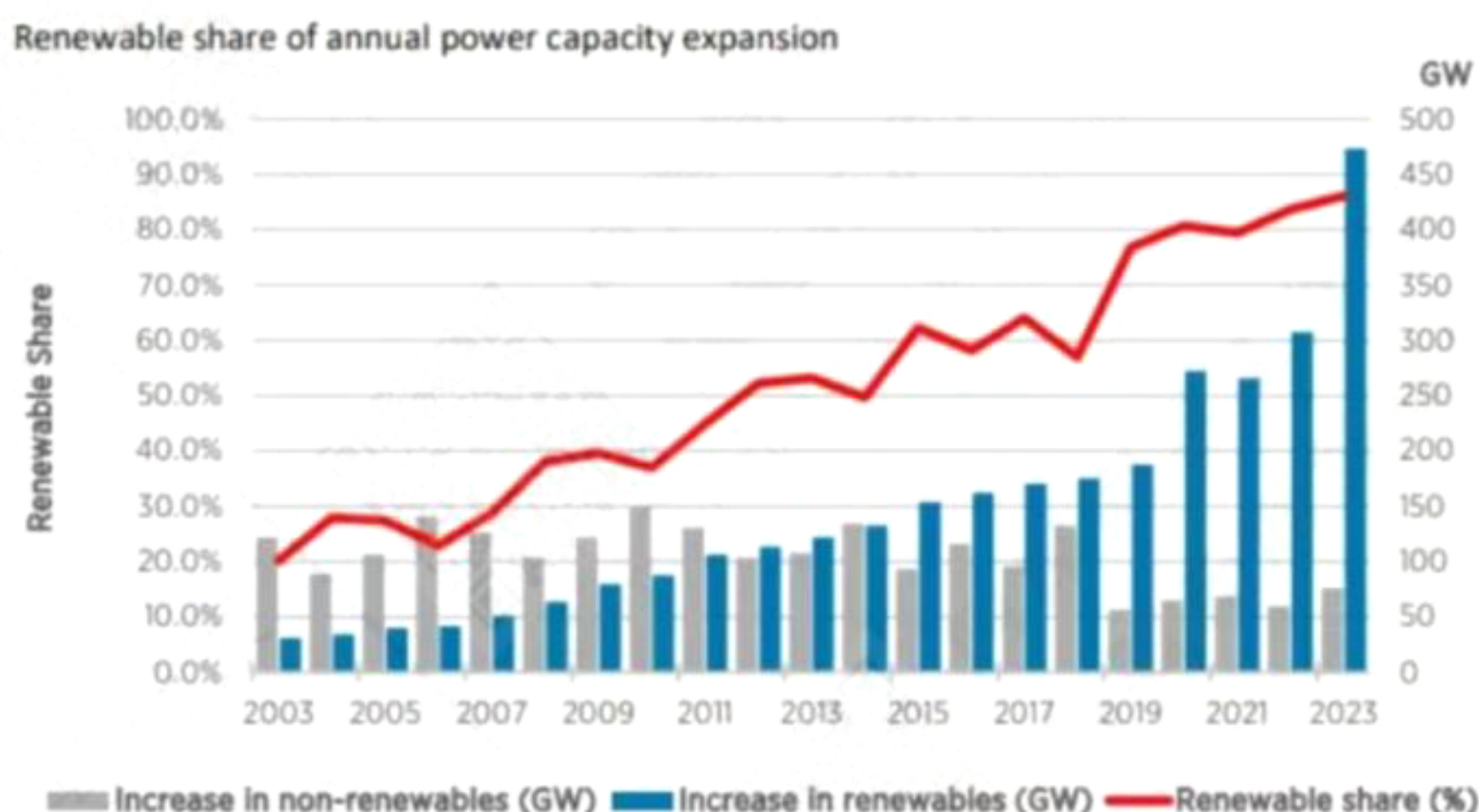
10.Which civilization has a long tradition but lacks extensive written records?

- A. The Egyptian civilization.
B. The Sumerian civilization
C. None of the civilizations
D. The Hindu civilization.

11. What distinguishes China from other nations mentioned in the text in terms of history?

- A. It has an uninterrupted written record of its long history.
B. It has the earliest mature pictographic characters.
C. It has the oldest language spoken on this earth.
D. It has diversified historical traditions.

Questions 12 to 15: Read the chart about global renewable share and decide whether the following statements are True or False.



12. The chart shows a consistent rise in the adoption of renewable energy sources and a simultaneous decrease in the expansion of non-renewable energy capacity.

13. In 2023, the expansion of renewable power capacity increased compared to 2022 and stayed well above the long-term trend.

14. In 2023, the percentage of renewables in overall capacity growth rose to around 85%, a substantial increase from the record of 2022.

15. Renewable energy has had a higher generation capacity compared to non-renewable energy since 2015.

Part II Read and Reason (30 marks, 30 minutes)

Question 16 is based on the following text.

Humankind's curiosity about what lies up above in space has long outpaced its interest in what lurks beneath the surface of the Earth's oceans. ① Indeed, more humans have visited the moon than the bottom of the sea. ② Even if only to better understand what constitutes nearly three quarters of the Earth's surface, the vast majority of which remains unexplored. ③ Such is the disparity that contemporary scientists possess more precise maps of the Martian surface than they do of the ocean depths. ④ But humans would do well to learn more about what lies in the

ocean's depths. Such was the case presented by experts during the 54th annual World Economic Forum in Davos.

16. What is the right order of the numbered sentences?

- A. ②③④① B. ④①②③ C. ①②④③ D. ③①④②

Look at the following picture and answer question 17.



17. Which of the following logical fallacies does the advertisement use?

- A. Bandwagon: A sense of social proof is created that since many people are adopting a particular product, service, or idea, it must be the right choice.
- B. Ad hominem: An argument is rebutted by shifting the focus away from the actual argument and directing attention toward the person presenting it.
- C. Hasty generalization: A conclusion is drawn without considering all relevant factors or having sufficient evidence to support it.
- D. False dilemma: A false sense of limited options is created, forcing people to choose between two extremes, even though other viable alternatives might exist.

Question 18 is based on the following text.

While moderate caffeine consumption can provide certain benefits, particularly for individuals seeking assistance with alertness and concentration, recent research suggests that the cognitive advantages of coffee may be overstated. Scholars contend that the positive effects of caffeine are short-lived and can lead to sleep disruptions,

which in turn may trigger hypomanic or manic-mood episodes characterized by high energy, racing thoughts, and impulsive behaviors. Consequently, if one relies on coffee as a means of sustaining focus during work hours, the long-term consequences may outweigh the short-term benefits.

18. Which of the following best describes the author's reasoning?

- A. The author makes a comparison between two theories by providing an example
- B. The author presents a new theory in response to an existing well-established one
- C. The author introduces a controversial viewpoint backed by empirical evidence
- D. The author challenges a popular notion by providing evidence that is contrary to it.

Questions 19 to 21 are based on the following text.

For people who use wheelchairs, air travel can be a nightmare. Now the US government is trying to change that by proposing new standards for how airlines must accommodate passengers with disabilities.

“Transportation is still inaccessible for far too many people, and that's certainly true for aviation,” Transportation Secretary Pete Buttigieg said in a call with reporters.

“This is about making sure that all Americans can travel safely and with dignity.”

The Department of Transportation invited dozens of other disability advocates to Washington in February to talk about the proposed regulation. It would make mishandling of wheelchairs an automatic violation of the Air Carrier Access Act—making it easier to hold airlines accountable when they damage or delay the return of a wheelchair, Buttigieg said.

When airlines break a wheelchair or other mobility device, disability advocates argue, it's not like any other piece of luggage. **“People don't realize that this is a part of my body, if this is broken you've broken my legs,”** said Illinois Senator Tammy Duckworth, who lost both of her legs in the Iraq war. Duckworth has pushed to require airlines to disclose how many wheelchairs they damage. She says they broke 892 wheelchairs in a single month last year.

The proposed rule would mandate that airlines provide more training for employees and contractors who physically assist passengers with disabilities and

handle passengers' wheelchairs and other mobility devices. The proposed rule includes hefty fines of more than \$ 100,000 per incident. The major airlines have not said anything publicly about that.

The immediate reaction from disability advocates was largely positive, though some expressed disappointment about what the proposed rule leaves out. “The rule certainly is doing something, but don't know if it's doing enough,” said Emily Ladau, a disability rights activist and author of the book *Demystifying Disability*.

Under the rule, airlines would be required to provide “prompt assistance” to passengers with disabilities when boarding and deplaning. Ladau says she wants more clarity about how that is defined “I can't tell you how many times I have sat on the plane waiting for sometimes close to an hour, if not more, just to have my wheelchair returned to me,” Ladau said, “and occasionally have found that my wheelchair was not returned to me promptly because it was damaged.

The proposed rule does not include disabled passengers’ “ultimate dream” to stay in their own wheelchair on a plane. “We are working toward it,” Buttigieg said, while acknowledging that allowing passengers to stay in their wheelchairs on the plane will be “very challenging” from a safety and engineering perspective.

19. Which statement best summarizes the main objective of the proposed regulations?
- A. To raise public awareness of the need to protect passengers' mobility devices.
 - B. To eliminate the possibilities of wheelchair damage during flights.
 - C. To increase training for airline employees to assist passengers with disabilities.
 - D. To promote safer and more dignified air travel for disabled passengers.
20. Why does the author quote the underlined sentence said by Senator Tammy Duckworth?
- A. To draw attention to the financial cost of traveling with a wheelchair.
 - B. To criticize airlines for their lack of wheelchair repair services.
 - C. To emphasize the severe damage caused by air travel to wheelchairs.
 - D. To highlight the grave impact of wheelchair damage on disabled passengers.

21. What is a key concern of disability advocates regarding the newly proposed regulations?

- A. It requires insufficient fines for each violation.
- B. It does not include the term allowing disabled passengers to stay in their own wheelchairs.
- C. It lacks transparency among airlines on wheelchair damages
- D. It does not require to provide prompt assistance during boarding and deplaning.

Questions 22 to 25 are based on the following text.

Weigi, or Go, is one of the oldest board games from China. Invented around 4,000 years ago, it is still enjoyed by many today. When the ancient Chinese invented weigi, they could have never imagined its profound impact on China and the wider world. The game earned great respect in ancient China as one of China's four arts necessary for becoming a learned scholar. Nowadays, weigi remains an important cultural icon in China as young generations embrace the game and older players rediscover their love for it.

By now you may be wondering just what makes the game so popular. The answer is simple: The game is more than just a game. It offers its players a wealth of benefits. It serves as a military strategy game that sharpens intelligence, while also providing philosophical insights that shape one's mind and enrich one's character.

The objective of weigi players is to use their stones to form territories on the board, either by occupying empty spaces or blocking their opponent. Despite its seemingly simple rules, weigi is incredibly complicated. It has almost infinite variations within the game and playing the game requires a great deal of calculation. Some draw a comparison between weili and military stratagems: 'Two sides with equal strength engage in a battle to control a fixed territory. The stones symbolize manpower, while the board represents the territory. Players take on the role of field commanders, and victory is determined by the extent of territory captured. It is akin to a war between evenly matched military powers.'

Many Chinese people love weigi for the essence of Chinese philosophy embedded in it. The game informs perspectives on a player's conduct and deeds, way

of thinking and reasoning, and overall approach to life. For example, we can find Confucian principles in this game, such as the concept of Golden Mean, which advises us to follow standard of moderation in dealing with others and in one's everyday conduct. We can see this through players navigating the delicate balance between aggressive attacks and solid defenses.

The time-tested brilliance of weiqi allows us to honor our cultural heritage, keep our minds sharp, and learn a few important life lessons along the way. In the game of weiqi, we may have an advantage over our opponent, but we should not become complacent or careless. Similarly, when we have good fortune in life, we should always be prepared for potential challenges or unexpected obstacles. Another lesson from weiqi is that, even if we are losing our game or are going through difficult times, we should remain proactive and strive for success.

22. What is the primary reason contributing to the widespread popularity of weiqi?

- A. Its role as an important cultural icon in China.
- B. Its strong implications for military stratagems.
- C. Its immense complexity and competitiveness.
- D. Its strategic depth and philosophical insights.

23. How does the text describe the complexity of weiqi?

- A. Weiqi involves deducing an opponent's style and adapting strategies accordingly.
- B. Weiqi relies heavily on military strategies despite having simple rules.
- C. Weiqi exhibits nearly limitless variations and necessitates thorough calculation.
- D. Weiqi demands exceptional judgment and adaptability to form territories.

24. In what way does weiqi reflect ancient Chinese wisdom?

- A. By promoting a balance between aggressiveness and restraint in the game.
- B. By fostering players to acquire diverse ways of thinking and taking action.
- C. By emphasizing the need to make sacrifices in order to achieve victory.
- D. By encouraging logical thinking in both the game and everyday conduct.

25. What is a lesson that can be learned from playing weight?

- A. The value of weighing risks and rewards prior to pivotal decision-making.
- B. The necessity of planning ahead and learning from mistakes.
- C. The necessity of avoiding complacency in times of prosperity.
- D. The value of staying focused and being patient in changing circumstances.

Part III Write and Create (40 marks, 35 minutes)

Campus Career Corner is a relatively new social network platform where college students share information, advice and experiences related to career opportunities and job market trends. You happened to read a post by Alex.

Navigating AI in My Future Career

Alex, September 20th, 2024, 5:18 P.M.

As a college student, I am both excited and anxious about entering the job market. I've read extensively about how AI's increasing role in industries can enhance efficiency by automating tasks. However, AI might also replace some jobs and eliminate human roles altogether. I'm unsure how this might impact my career prospects. Should I be worried about AI taking over jobs, or should I focus on its positive potential in the workplace?

Reply to Alex and state your opinion with reasons and examples. You should write between 200 and 250 words.